

Behold! thy King cometh

The prophecy in [Zechariah 9:9](#) presents us with an interesting situation because none of the gospels *explicitly* tell us when Jesus rode on the female (mother) ass ([Matthew 21:2,3](#)) and yet the prophecy required that Jesus rode on each of them (either together or separately).

1. The journey began with Jesus and His disciples [walking] from Bethany ([John 12:1](#)) until He and the “*multitude of disciples*” with Him ([Luke 19:37](#)) were close to Bethany and Bethphage ([Luke 19:29](#), [Matthew 21:1](#), [Mark 11:1](#); both villages were on the eastern slope/side of the mount of Olives).
2. Jesus sends two of the disciples to a nearby village to get the female ass and her colt ([Mat 21:2,3](#)).
3. Before descending the western side of the mount of Olives ([Luke 19:35-37](#)) the ass and her colt were brought to Jesus, they were both covered with the disciples’ clothes ([Matthew 21:7](#)), and He sat on the colt (“*young ass*”; [John 12:14](#), [Luke 19:35](#), [Mark 11:7](#); [Matthew](#) does not specify which ass that Jesus sat on, only that He sat on the clothes).
4. The disciples spread their clothes in the way ([Luke 19:36](#)) during the ascent up the eastern side and/or the crossing of the plateau of the mount of Olives.
5. The steep descent down the western side of the mount of Olives is now the only opportunity* for Jesus to ride the mother ass and so [probably] He does. The colt follows it’s mother and learns how to navigate the terrain without a burden.
6. Much people from Jerusalem (there for the feast; and those that witnessed Lazarus’ resurrection [John 12:17,18](#)) come out to meet Jesus as He is approaching with branches of palm trees ([John 12:12,13](#), [Matthew 21:8](#), [Mark 11:8](#))
7. At some point before entering Jerusalem, Jesus *finds* a young ass and sits on it ([John 12:14](#)). Since the prophecy was already fulfilled He *finds* “*a young ass*” and not “*the young ass*”. Because of [John 12:15](#) it may have been the same colt that He was riding at the beginning of the journey.
8. He enters into Jerusalem and heads for the temple (it is unknown when he dismounted the young ass but it was probably before entering the temple).

* This restriction is created because of one simple fact in scripture: first, we take the groups of people that cried ([Mat 21:9](#), [Mar 11:9,10](#), [Luke 19:38](#), [John 12:13](#)). If we look at the groups of people as an anchor point in time (from before the descent down the western side of the mount of Olives to before entering Jerusalem) and then look at all four gospels we notice something very interesting in the order of events:

Book	Step 1	Step 2
Matthew	Jesus gets on one (or both) of the asses	The crowd from Jerusalem and the disciples cried “ <i>Hosanna to the Son of David: Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord; Hosanna in the highest</i> ”
Mark	Jesus gets on the colt	The crowd from Jerusalem and the disciples cried “ <i>Hosanna: Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord: Blessed be the kingdom of our father David, that cometh in the name of the Lord: Hosanna in the highest.</i> ”
Luke	Jesus gets on the colt	The disciples said with a loud voice “ <i>Blessed be the King that cometh in the name of the Lord: peace in heaven, and glory in the highest.</i> ”
John	The crowd from Jerusalem cried “ <i>Hosanna: Blessed is the King of Israel that cometh in the name of the Lord</i> ”.	Jesus gets on a young ass

- Jesus was on a colt/young ass both before and after the anchor point leaving only one opportunity to ride the mother ass: the descent of the western side of the mount of Olives.